

COMPULSION AND ADDICTION

Our culture teaches us about shame—it dictates what is acceptable and what is not. We weren't born craving perfect bodies. We weren't born afraid to tell our stories. We weren't born with a fear of getting too old to feel valuable. We weren't born with a Pottery Barn catalog in one hand and heartbreaking debt in the other. Shame comes from outside of us—from the messages and expectations of our culture. What comes from the inside of us is a very human need to belong, to relate.

Broné Brown

I cannot in all good conscience talk about Financial Phenotypes, Money Stories and Money Types without talking about addiction and compulsion. That's because a small percentage of you are caught up in a cycle of addictive and compulsive behaviour when it comes to your finances and what I want to do is highlight that, to acknowledge this is something entirely different from the usual Money Type or Story that you can create a suite of habits for. It's a situation where your brain has quite literally been hijacked and I want to encourage you to seek professional help.

It's important to understand there is a difference between someone who enjoys a little shopping and a shopping addict. There is a difference between someone who enjoys a flutter at the tracks and a gambling addict.

While we might logically understand the difference between enjoyment and addiction, researchers and scientists still don't understand why we